

Police reform could lose partner in Justice Dept.

Ongoing settlement talks with Worcester, others imperiled, advocates say

By Dan Glaun
GLOBE STAFF

Local civil rights advocates are warning that new leadership at the Department of Justice may undermine federal police reform cases, including ongoing settlement negotiations with the Worcester Police Department.

Within days of Trump's inauguration, the Justice Department's new chief of staff, Chad Mizelle, sent a pair of memos ordering civil rights prosecutors to pull back from existing cases.

One told attorneys in the DOJ's Civil Rights Division to pause filing new complaints and other legal documents. Another ordered staffers to notify leadership of any settlements with police departments finalized in the last 90 days, saying the department "may wish to reconsider" those agreements. And the DOJ has deleted a major report on police reform from its website, in compliance with executive orders regulating government publications.

Sophia Hall, deputy litigation director of Lawyers for Civil Rights, said that even under supportive administrations, the DOJ only has the capacity to investigate a small percentage of police misconduct claims. Under Trump, Hall expects that police

CIVIL RIGHTS, Page A7

More tariffs from Trump

The president said he would impose a 25 percent tariff on foreign steel and aluminum imports. **A6.**

Lament in labs

Local officials say federal funding cuts will upend scientific research at universities and hospitals. **B1.**

Federal courts may be bulwark against Trump

Orders, appeals flood system; process lengthy

By Mattathias Schwartz
NEW YORK TIMES

PHILADELPHIA — More than 40 lawsuits filed in recent days by state attorneys general, unions, and nonprofits seek to erect a bulwark in the federal courts against President Trump's blitzkrieg of executive actions that have upended much of the federal government and challenged the Constitution's system of checks and balances.

Unlike the opening of Trump's first term in 2017, little significant resistance to his second term has arisen in the streets, the halls of Congress, or within his own Republican Party. For now at least, lawyers say, the judicial branch may be it.

"The courts really are the front line," said Skye Perryman, CEO of Democracy Forward, which has filed nine lawsuits and won four court orders against the Trump administration.

The multipronged legal pushback has already

FEDERAL JUDGES, Page A6

Venezuelans in Mass. in limbo as protection ends

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Anthony, a Venezuelan father of three who lives in Lynn, is dreading the day his family becomes undocumented.

In less than two months, the temporary immigration status they depend on to work and live legally in the United States will expire under a Trump administration directive revoking a Biden-era policy that shielded the family from deportation.

Returning to Venezuela does not feel like a viable option for Anthony, 31, who says he likely cannot access adequate medical care there for his sons, who have autism, and would likely fall back into severe poverty amid surging inflation and food insecurity. He feels he has no other choice than to quietly fall into the shadows, joining hundreds of thousands of other immigrants living without authorization in Massachusetts, along with his wife, their 2-year-old twin sons, and their 6-year-old daughter.

VENEZUELAN, Page A7

School districts face more cuts



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Fourth-graders sat with their teacher, Karen Rixford, as they worked on a lesson late last month inside Ashby Elementary School.

Officials caught in another cycle of rising costs, falling US assistance

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

ASHBY — Residents of this town near the New Hampshire border have been on a roller coaster since early December over the future of its only school, which has just 150 students.

At first the news was bleak: Ashby Elementary was one of two schools the North Middlesex Regional School Committee targeted for closure in December to remedy a projected \$3.5 million shortfall for next year. One month later, the committee rescinded that vote, which also spared Spaulding Memorial School in neighboring

Townsend.

But on Thursday night, the committee moved forward with closing Ashby as part of the superintendent's proposed budget, which would also likely require voters approve a tax increase to fully address the shortfall.

"It's going to be detrimental to the community," said Richie Sun, who has children in the second and third grades at Ashby. "People will move out and people won't move in. Home prices will fall."

The precarious situation highlights the bleak financial picture many Massachusetts

SCHOOL FUNDING, Page A10

EAGLES SNATCH SUPER VICTORY



DAVID J. PHILLIP/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Philadelphia Eagles players celebrated with the Vince Lombardi Trophy after they won Super Bowl LIX in a 40-22 blowout against the Kansas City Chiefs on Sunday. It was the second Super Bowl title for Philadelphia, while the Chiefs failed in their quest to become the first NFL team to win three in a row. It was a rough game for Chiefs quarterback Patrick Mahomes, who threw two interceptions — including a pick-6. **C1.**

Some Uber, Lyft drivers say wage law hurt pay

'It's getting worse and worse. Before, it was much better.'

RAFAEL, a driver who says his earnings have fallen since Uber and Lyft's new minimum hourly wage went into effect in Massachusetts

By Katie Johnston
GLOBE STAFF

Rafael doesn't mind working hard. Or driving a lot. That combination has helped him reach his goal of earning \$3,000 a week behind the wheel for Uber and Lyft, prompting a fellow driver to give him the nickname "Ironman."

These days, though, he said, he has to put in at least 90 hours a week to reach that amount.

That's 10 hours more than his already hefty workload before the ride-hailing companies agreed to adopt a new minimum wage for Massachusetts drivers in August, at \$32.50 an hour.

"It's getting worse and worse," said Rafael, who lives in the Boston area and asked that his last name not be used to protect his job security. "Before, it was much better."

He's not alone. Contrary to

the idea that the new minimum wage would increase pay, a number of veteran drivers interviewed by The Boston Globe said their overall earnings have taken a hit since Uber and Lyft's minimum hourly wage went into effect in Massachusetts. Intended to give them greater stability and, ostensibly, the ability to make more money, the new earnings base instead seems to

RIDESHARE DRIVERS, Page A10



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

GREEN LINE ACCIDENT — Workers for the MBTA on Sunday assessed a train that had been involved in a collision at East Somerville Station. Officials said five people were injured when a train struck an out-of-service train. Both trains derailed. **B1.**

A report from the state attorney's general office detailed predatory practices targeting utility customers. B1.

Boston officials delayed implementing a zoning plan that would allow skyscrapers in the Downtown Crossing area after residents criticized it. D1.

GoFundMe donors have kicked in a quarter billion dollars to rebuild Los Angeles after wildfires, the largest such effort by the site. A2.

Israeli soldiers withdrew from a corridor dividing the Gaza Strip, leaving nearly all of the territory's north region. A3.

For the first time since 2016, it's Boston College vs. Boston University in Monday's mens Beanpot tourney final. C1.



Are you diggin' it?

Monday: Sunny, breezy. High 34-39, low 15-20.

Tuesday: Clouds return. High 33-38, low 18-23.

Sunrise: 6:47. Sunset: 5:10.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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